

Niri Workflow

This is a short doc to document all the up-to-date changes I have for my current workflow 2026-03-17. Similar to LARBS but with no preamble on why CLI and keyboard-driven workflows are superior. I'll just get straight into the meat and potatoes.

Status Bar

I switched to Noctalia Bar after Floating Pill Waybar. This bar is finally my endgame: minimal distractions and plenty of important information. And only a few things have color, which helps with the distractions. It's an excellent bar despite running at ~300-500 MB, almost 9-10x more than Waybar, but I think it's worth it.

It's especially useful with Niri to show which windows are open per workspace using icons.

Keybindings

These are still Luke Smith-esque with my tweaks.

It turns out scrolling/niri was not a meme. It's extremely useful when combined with groups/tabs. I do keep the amount of windows open per workspace to a minimum anyway, but it's still nice when a new window *doesn't* resize itself. I live mostly in the terminal and use tmux to manage most of my terminal windows and use sessions per task/project. The only GUI programs I use are below:

- Browser
- Anki
- Zathura/PDF viewer
- Gimp (in the future for YT)
- Darktable (in the future for YT)
- OBS (in the future for YT)



Bar

- **Mod+B** – toggle bar on or off
- **Mod+Shift+B** – relaunch bar if necessary



Programs

Again, most of the programs I use are basically CLI/TUIs that are well regarded/recommended by Luke Smith, although I swapped for better alternatives to suit my needs. Aerc replaced Neomutt because as wonderful as Luke's mutt-wizard script is, Aerc with IMAP is much simpler for my needs; I don't need offline mail. After running his mail setup for a few years, I realized it was overkill for my needs.

- **Mod+D** – launch rofi run
- **Mod+Shift+S** – launch rofi passmenu
- **Mod+Enter** – launch terminal(kitty)
- **Mod+Shift+Enter** – launch tmux session viewer (newt)
- **Mod+E** – launch aerc (email)
- **Mod+Shift+E** – launch miniflux(in browser)
- **Mod+W** – launch browser (qutebrowser)
- **Mod+Shift+W** – launch tmux quick sessions
- **Mod+R** – open currently reading pdf
- **Mod+Shift+R** – open pdf/epub picker
- **Mod+N** – launch system monitor (btop)
- **Mod+A** – launch address book(abook)
- **Mod+M** – launch music player (ncmpcpp)
- **Mod+Y** – left click mouse
- **Mod+Shift+Y** – launch wiremix (audio control)
- **Mod+T** – launch torrent UI (stig)
- **Mod+Shift+T** – toggle transmission daemon
- **Ctrl+;** – move mouse left

- **Ctrl+' – move mouse right**

System

- **Mod+Shift+D – open system utilities menu**
- **Mod+C – clipboard history**
- **Mod+Q – kill active window**
- **Mod+Shift+X – exit niri**
- **Mod+Shift+Space – toggle all windows floating**
- **Mod+Backspace – power menu**
- **Mod+Shift+Backspace – lock screen**
- **XF86MonBrightnessDown – decrease screen brightness by 5% (laptop only)**
- **XF86MonBrightnessUp – increase screen brightness by 5% (laptop only)**
- **Alt+= – system volume +5**
- **Alt+- – system volume -5**

Screenshots

- **Print – screenshot active monitor**
- **Mod+S – screenshot menu**

Window Navigation / Layout

- **Mod+L – focus left column**
- **Mod+H – focus right column**
- **Mod+Shift+H – swap left (window)**
- **Mod+Shift+L – swap right (window)**
- **Mod+[– focus first column**
- **Mod+] – focus last column**
- **Mod+Shift+[– move column to first (window)**
- **Mod+Shift+]L – move column to last (window)**
- **Mod+Shift+Space – toggle floating**
- **Mod+U – maximize column (fake fullscreen)**
- **Mod+F – toggle fullscreen**
- **Mod+O – toggle overview (not used but nice to have)**

Groups

- **Mod+G – toggle group**
- **Mod+Tab – move window into or out of group (group left, window right)**
- **Mod+Shift+Tab – move window into or out of group (group right window left)**

Workspace / Tab Navigation

- **Mod+J – move down (workspace or group tab)**
- **Mod+K – move up (workspace or group tab)**

Resize

- **Mod+minus – shrink window width**
- **Mod+equal – expand window width**
- **Mod+Shift+minus – cycle through preset widths**



Monitors

- **Mod+comma** – focus left monitor
- **Mod+period** – focus right monitor
- **Mod+Shift+period** – move window to right monitor
- **Mod+Shift+comma** – move window to left monitor



Workspaces

- **Mod+1-0** – switch to workspace 1-10
- **Mod+Shift+1-0** – move window to workspace 1-10



Mouse

- **Mod+LMB** – move window
- **Mod+Shift+LMB** – resize window
- **Mod+Scroll Down** – next workspace
- **Mod+Scroll Up** – previous workspace